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Submitter Information

Name: Josh Cumbee

Email: [REDACTED]

General Comment

This issue marks a critical turning point for the future of American industry. For decades the US has been a vanguard of the creative space - leveraging free speech, capitalistic principles and a meritocratic system to birth some of the most canonic art in human history.

That legacy and store of value is under attack. The precedent the US sets in regards to the value of training data is not an attack on its multi-trillion dollar tech oligopolies, but a safeguard in ensuring the rich American art and cultural heritage retains its value in a new technological age. The promise of generative AI as an aid and tool in human tasks cannot be understated, and a reasonable resolution regarding its development is necessary - but not at the expense of the livelihoods of the millions of creative workers and small businesses that grease the gears of American cultural export.

Our future as a country can only hope to be exponential, not merely iterative. Generative AI, as an unchecked, sole driving engine is predictively Bayesian in output. Over time, left unregulated, it will consume the small lower-tier of creative industries that create human mastery in the fields we prize most, and in doing so neuter the next class of artists, writers, musicians and filmmakers. We must not allow generative AI to freely train on our national canon of copyright - we must set a precedent of compensation and ensure the future of American creativity does not die in a tsunami of AI-generated mediocre slop.